CHARLOTTE FRENCH
3 Fuller Gardens
South Marston
SWINDON
SN3 4RP

Wednesday 11 March 2026

Planning Application: S/RES/25/1389
Reserved Matters – Parcels R1–R2, New Eastern Villages

Dear Planning Officer,

I write regarding the above Reserved Matters application as the resident of 3 Fuller Gardens, which directly adjoins the northern boundary of the application site.

I recognise that outline planning permission has established the principle of residential development in this location. My comments therefore relate specifically to the reserved matters of layout, scale, appearance and landscaping, and particularly the relationship between the proposed development and the existing residential properties along Fuller Gardens and Manor Park.

RELATIONSHIP TO NEIGHBOURING PROPERTIES

Based on the submitted layout drawings, my property appears to be directly affected by the positioning of Plots 187 and 188, which are located respectively to the south and east of my garden boundary.

These plots appear to present side elevations along both the southern and eastern boundaries of my garden, creating a side-to-side relationship between the proposed dwellings and my property. As a result, my property would be affected by development on two boundaries, which may increase the sense of enclosure and impact on residential amenity compared with neighbouring properties that are affected along a single boundary.

Given the proximity of these dwellings to existing homes on Fuller Gardens, I would be grateful if the Local Planning Authority could confirm the separation distances between Plots 187 and 188 and the existing properties, and whether these distances comply with the standards set out within the Council's Residential Design Guide SPD.

LANDSCAPE BUFFER AND BOUNDARY TREATMENT

The submitted drawings indicate the presence of a planting strip and maintenance corridor along the northern edge of the development, separating the proposed dwellings from the existing properties on Fuller Gardens.

Given that this boundary forms the primary interface between the new development and the existing residential area, I would be grateful if the Local Planning Authority could confirm:

• the width of the proposed landscape buffer along this boundary
• the extent of structural tree planting proposed within this strip
• the purpose and long-term management of the maintenance corridor, including how access for maintenance will be undertaken.

Ensuring that this boundary provides a meaningful landscape buffer is particularly important given the proximity of the proposed dwellings to existing homes.

GARDEN DEPTH AND SEPARATION

The layout drawings indicate that several plots along the northern boundary of the site, including those around Plots 187–191, appear to have relatively shallow rear gardens.

Given that these plots back directly onto the boundary with existing homes on Fuller Gardens and Manor Park, I would be grateful if the Local Planning Authority could confirm that the proposed garden depths meet the Council's guidance for private amenity space and provide an appropriate separation between new and existing properties.

DISTRIBUTION OF AFFORDABLE HOUSING

Having reviewed the Affordable Housing Layout submitted with the application, it appears that a notable proportion of the shared ownership and affordable rent dwellings are located in the area immediately adjacent to the northern boundary near my property.

Based on the submitted drawings, approximately 24 affordable units appear to be proposed across the development. Of these, approximately nine units appear to be located in close proximity to the boundary with existing homes on Fuller Gardens and Manor Park **(Ref Pg 4)**.

Given that this part of the site forms the development edge where the new scheme meets the existing residential area, I would be grateful if the Local Planning Authority could confirm whether the distribution of affordable housing within the scheme accords with the design principles for integrated and tenure-blind communities established through the New Eastern Villages design codes.

TRANSITION IN HOUSING CHARACTER

The existing properties along Fuller Gardens and Manor Park are predominantly larger detached family homes set within relatively spacious plots.

The proposed dwellings along the northern boundary appear to include smaller semi-detached and terraced properties on more compact plots. While a mix of housing types is expected within new developments, I would welcome confirmation that the layout provides an appropriate transition in scale and character between the new development and the existing residential area.

DESIGN OF THE DEVELOPMENT EDGE

From review of the layout drawings it appears that much of the northern boundary of the development is formed by the rear gardens and rear elevations of the proposed dwellings.

As this boundary represents the primary interface between the new development and the existing residential neighbourhood, I would welcome confirmation that the design of this edge has been carefully considered and provides an appropriate transition between the new and existing communities.

DAYLIGHT AND OUTLOOK

The proposed dwellings located immediately to the south and south-east of my property may also affect the level of daylight and outlook experienced within my garden.

My garden is oriented predominantly eastwards, and the introduction of two-storey dwellings in close proximity along both the southern and eastern boundaries may reduce early morning sunlight and increase the sense of enclosure along these boundaries. I would therefore ask the Local Planning Authority to consider whether the positioning and scale of these dwellings could have an impact on the amenity of neighbouring properties.

EVOLUTION OF THE LAYOUT

During review of the submitted drawings it appears that the plot numbering and layout adjacent to my property have changed between earlier submissions and the current plans. For example, plots currently identified as 187 and 188 appear to have been numbered 186 and 187 in earlier affordable housing layout drawings.

While this may reflect revisions to the detailed layout, I would welcome confirmation that the current arrangement remains consistent with the design principles established through the outline consent and the New Eastern Villages design codes.

CONCLUSION

While I support the principle of development within the New Eastern Villages allocation, I respectfully request that the Council carefully consider the relationship between the proposed layout and the existing properties along Fuller Gardens and Manor Park.

In particular, I would be grateful if the Local Planning Authority could confirm:

• the separation distances between Plots 187 and 188-190 and existing homes

• the width and specification of the proposed landscape buffer along the northern boundary

• the management and purpose of the maintenance corridor

• whether the garden depths along the boundary plots are sufficient

• whether the distribution of affordable housing provides an integrated layout

• whether the development provides an appropriate transition between the new development and the existing residential edge.

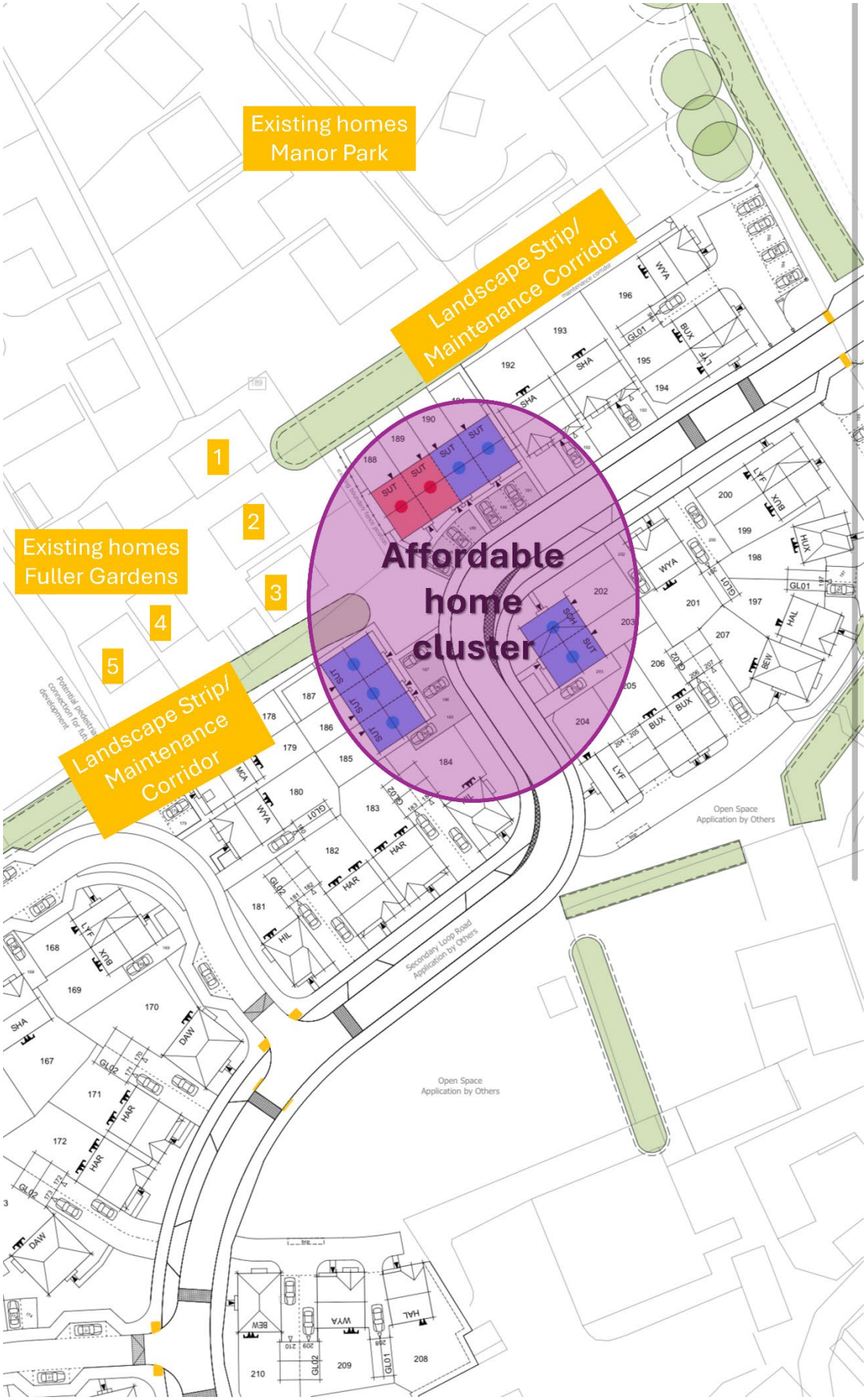
Given that this boundary represents the interface between the proposed development and an established residential neighbourhood, ensuring an appropriate level of separation and landscape buffering is particularly important in this location.

Ensuring that the boundary between the proposed development and the existing neighbourhood is carefully designed will help the scheme integrate more sensitively with the surrounding area while still allowing the development to proceed.

Regards,

Charlotte French
3 Fuller Gardens

[redacted]


Existing homes
Manor Park
Landscape Strip/
Maintenance Corridor
Existing homes
Fuller Gardens
1
2
3
4
5
Affordable
home
cluster
Landscape Strip/
Maintenance
Corridor
Open Space
Application by Others
Secondary Loop Road
Application by Others
Open Space
Application by Others